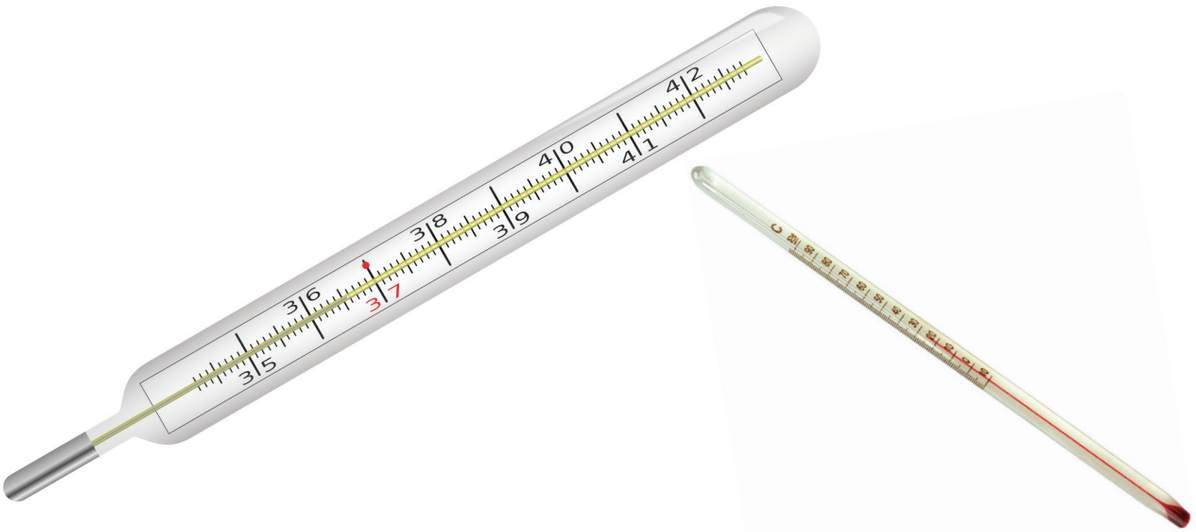


5. Place the thermometer under the patients tongue and instruct him not to bite it but to close his lips gently. He should not talk or cough.
6. Keep the thermometer in the mouth for 1 to 3 minutes.
7. Place the tips of three fingers (never the thumb) gently over the radial artery at the wrist.
8. Feel the pulsation carefully before starting to count. Note the strength and regularity of the beats.
9. Using a watch with seconds hand, count the number of beats for one minute.
10. Feel or watch the rise and fall of the patient's chest.
11. Count each rise and fall as one respiration. Count for a full minute.
12. While counting the rate, note also
    i. Rhythm – regular or irregular
    ii. Depth – shallow, normal or deep
    iii. Sound – quiet or noisy
    iv. Any discomfort or difficulty in breathing
13. Record the temperature, pulse and respiration on the chart or in the TPR chart
14. Taking and replacing thermometer should be in rotation making sure they remain in disinfectant for at least 3 minutes before being used for another patient.
15. After the procedure, clean and reset the tray for next use.

3.3 BLOOD PRESSURE

Definition:

Blood pressure is the force or pressure of blood against the wall of blood vessels as it flows through them.

It depends on the following factors.

- Force of the heart beat
- Elasticity of the blood vessels walls
- Volume of blood in circulation
- Dilatation of contraction of the small arteries and capillaries.

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